[INCH-POUND]
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SUPERSEDING
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HOLDERS, ELECTRODE, SHIELDED METAL, ARC WELDING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description (CID) covers fully insulated, hand-held electrode holders used in shielded metal arc welding.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The electrode holders shall be of the following types and sizes. The type and size to be furnished shall be as specified (see 7.2(b)).

Type I - Positive-grip electrode holder

Size 400 - 400 amperes
Size 600 - 600 amperes

Type II - Tong electrode holder

Size 150 - 150 amperes
Size 200 - 200 amperes
Size 250 - 250 amperes
Size 300 - 300 amperes
Size 400 - 400 amperes
Size 500 - 500 amperes

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Defense Supply Center Richmond, ATTN: DSCR-VBD, 8000 Jefferson Davis Highway, Richmond, VA 23297-5610.

AMSC N/A FSC 3439

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 General requirements. The electrode holders shall be fully insulated to protect the welder from electrical shock and shall meet the requirements listed in table I. The holder shall be able to withstand a 6-foot drop on a hard surface without being damaged.

TABLE I. Electrode holder requirements.

Size	Amperage rating	Electrode diameter, inch maximum	Cable size, (AWG)
150	150	5/32	1/0
200	200	5/32	1/0
250	250	3/16	2/0
300	300	7/32	2/0
400	400	1/4	4/0
500	500	3/8	4/0
600	600	5/16	4/0

3.2 Holder body. The electrical current-carrying body of the holder shall be made of either managanese bronze, brass, or copper. The electrical conducting components of the holder shall have a minimum International Annealed Copper Standard (IACS) volumetric electrical conductivity of 20 percent at 68 degrees Fahrenheit when tested in accordance with ASTM B193.

3.3 Handle. The handle on the electrode holders shall not be less than 5 inches in length. The handle shall be made of insulating material to protect the user and to withstand the intense heat produced during the welding process.

3.4 Type I requirements. The type I holder shall be similar to that depicted in figure 1 and shall be designed in such a manner that a twist of the handle shall lock and unlock the electrode from the holder.

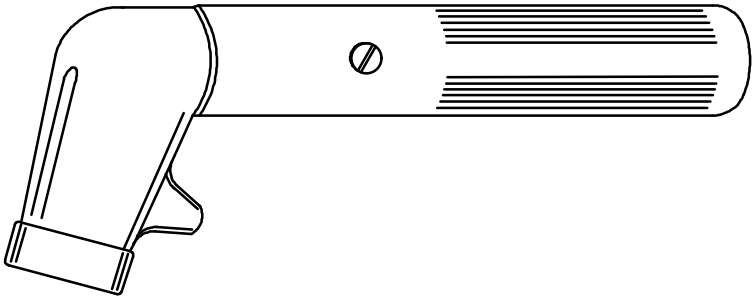

FIGURE 1. Type I electrode holder.

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3.5 Type II requirements. The type II holder shall be similar to that depicted in figure 2 and shall have a hinge and spring connecting the upper and lower jaws. Unless otherwise specified (see 7.2(c)), the lower jaw shall have grooves to hold the electrode at an angle of 90 degrees.

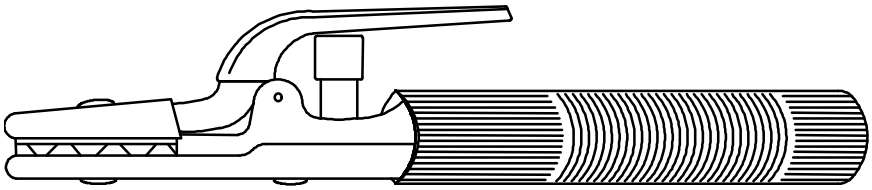

FIGURE 2. Type II electrode holder.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Product conformance. The products shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description; conform to the manufacturer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices; and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

6. PACKAGING. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified (7.2(d)).

7. NOTES

7.1 Source of documents.

7.1.1 Government documents. Copies of Federal documents may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

7.1.2 Source of documents. Applications for Copies of ASTM should be sent to ASTM, Inc., 100 Bar Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959

ASTM B 193 Standard Test Method for Resistivity of Electrical Conductor Materials

7.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

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a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Type and size of the holder to be furnished (see 2).
c. Electrode angle, if different (see 3.5).
d. Packaging, if different (see 6).

7.3 Part identification number (PIN). The following part identification numbering procedure is for government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

A-A-51161B-X-X

- Size:
  - 150 – 150 amperes
  - 200 – 200 amperes
  - 250 – 250 amperes
  - 300 – 300 amperes
  - 400 – 400 amperes
  - 500 – 500 amperes
  - 600 – 600 amperes
- Type:
  - A - Type I (Positive grip)
  - B - Type II (Tong)
- CID number

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians
Army - AL
Navy – SH
Air Force - 99

Reviewers
Air Force - 84
Navy – AS, MC, YD1

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
DLA - GS

(Project 3439-0878)

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